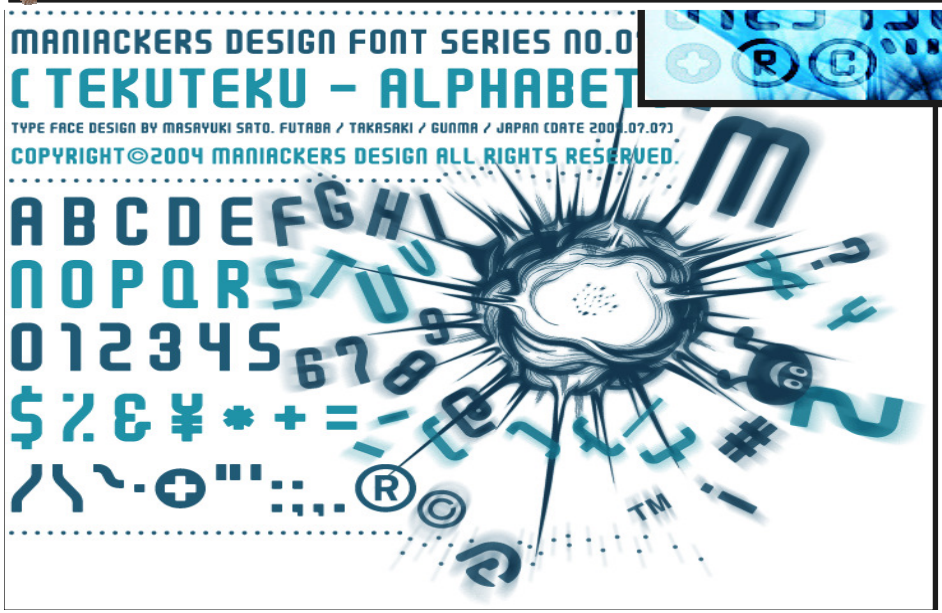


FOXCONN

Business E-mail Writings





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The Introduction of E-mail

E-mail (Email) is the most frequently-used feature on the Internet. Over the many years it has been used (going back to the early 1970s), lots of standards, traditions, and guidelines have developed regarding the formatting and layout of e-mail messages. If your messages fail to abide by these principles, they risk being unreadable & bring about misunderstanding or failure in communication.

1. Format or Layout

1.1 Headers: An e-mail message consists of two parts, the headers and the body. The main content of the message is in the body portion, but the headers have a vital role to play in making sure the message gets where it's supposed to go, and that the recipient knows who it's from and what it's about. Here is some information about headers.

From//To//CC: Where to come from, and where to go?

Subject: What's it all about? (any subject)

Attachment: What's attached

1.2 Body: The main part of a message; how should the text be formatted?

Writing principle: keep everything short. Keep your lines short, keep your paragraphs short, and keep the message short.

Salutation: Dear Mr./Mrs./Miss/Ms. Lee (A) Dear Chris
Dear Sir/Madam (B)
My Dear

Greetings: Hi or Hello(avoid Good morning or afternoon!)

Body of the email :

Complimentary close: Yours sincerely (A)

Yours faithfully (B)

Signature: Chao Lee (Everything is written and read on computer screen, so to write and read email message is quite different from that on the paper)

Sales Manager (title)

2.Guidelines for planning and organizing e-mail messages

As is true of any language, you must first plan your message before you can organize an effective e-mail message. Planning an e-mail message requires 4 steps:

2.1 Identify(明確) the objective. What do you hope to achieve in sending this message?

2.2 Identify the main idea. What do you want the receiver to do or understand?

2.3 Determine the supporting information. What does the receiver need to know about the main idea to respond to or understand your message?

2.4 Adjust the content to the receiver

After planning, you need to determine how to organize your mssge to achieve its purpose. As with letters, an e-mail message can be organized in either the *direct* or the *indirect* order.

Direct Order: presents the main idea first, followed by supporting information. In the message below, the main idea in the first sentence makes a routine request:

To: Mark Chien From: Michael Ai

Subject: Supplies Needed

Dear Mark,

Please prepare an order of supplies for HP Australia. The following supplies are needed:

a. Five containers of Heat Sink

b. 20 boxes of SP supplies

I know you are busy and have no assistants to deliver this order; therefore, Isaac, our purchaser, will come to your company at 9 a.m. tomorrow to pick up the order. Thank you for your help. Should you have any questions about this order, please feel free to let me know(to keep me informed or noted or posted).

Yours sincerely，

Michael！

Indirect Order: supporting information appears before the main idea. Use indirect order in e-mails that contain bad news for the receiver or that try to persuade the receiver:

To: Mark Chien From: Michael Ai

Subject: Reduction in Personnel

Dear Mark,

I certainly appreciate all the input you gave us on the staff-reduction decision we had to make. As you know, headquarters asked us to reduce the staff by 10 percent. If we could leave your division status quo, we would. However, 100 members of your staff must be retired or dismissed. I will meet you on Monday, Dec.10, to identify specific individuals. Once again I'd like to express my loving gratitude to you for all your efforts.

Yours sincerely，

Michael！

(Neutral beginning, supporting information, main idea)

Assignment 1:

(1)Tell your salesmen you are not happy with the sales.

(2) Tell your clients you are happy with their solution to the shortage of key materials.

(3) Tell your colleague you are not happy with his/her service.

indirect order

direct order

3. Some requirements for Business E-mail messages

3.1 Natural: business e-mail messages should try to avoid using a lot of jargons or business terminologies, otherwise this will perplex the receiver and waste time.

Email 1a

In compliance with the aforementioned agreement, dispatch of goods will be undertaken subsequent to receipt of said money.

Email 1b

As agreed, we shall forward the goods to you when we have received your cheque.

Business Jargons	Common Expressions
I acknowledge receipt of	I have received
At yr earliest convenience as soon as possible or at an early date	as soon as possible
Awaiting the favor of yr early response	I look forward to hearing from u soon

Business Jargons	Common Expressions
advise	tell, let us know, say
as per, in accordance with	according to
comply with our request	do as we request
deem	believe, consider
I am in receipt of	thank you for/I have received
free of charge	free
If it is within our power	If we can

in the event that	if, in case
in the near future	soon
in view of	because of
kindly	please
pursuant to, subsequent to	after
please be good enough to advise us	please tell us
we beg to inform you	I am writing to inform you
with regard to, in regard to, with respect to	regarding, concerning, relating to

E-mail 2a

We should be obliged if you could contact our Mrs. Ma at an early date.

E-mail 2b

E-mail 3a

Assuring you of our best attention at all times,

and awaiting the favor of your early response.

E-mail 3b

3.2 Readability: your writing should be lively and interesting, make your effort to avoid monotonous and boring expressions and sentences.

3.2.1 Choose the appropriate Long or Short sentences (conjunctions)

Short

Long

We intend to purchase new office furniture. We shall buy before the end of the financial year.

Short

Long

We need furniture for the offices.
We need furniture for the recreation area.

Our offices are quite small. The furniture would have to be compact.

The furniture should also be durable.
We would like to know about the guarantee on your product.

But sometimes long sentences will confuse readers and need to be shortened.

You are reminded that employees are required to arrive at work on time, which is 9:00, and not arrive at 9:30 when many of you have been arriving lately, because lateness costs the company a lot of money.

3.2.2 Try to avoid repeating the same word, phrase and sentence pattern, i.e. have a good command of diversified words, phrases and sentences that mean same.

It has been six months since we received a payment from you.

We last received a payment from you 6 months ago.

6 months have passed since your last payment.

6 months have gone by since you last paid us.

You have not paid us for 6 months

You last paid us 6 months ago.

We have not received a payment from you for 6 months.

Prices quoted include transportation and insurance costs.

4. Tone in business e-mail message writing

Tone plays a critical role in revealing the relationship between the writer and receiver. The polite, positive and cooperative tone is recommended when writing your clients; it is good to use soft, indirect and courteous tone in the message to your supervisors; it is advisable to adopt a friendly tone for friends & colleagues.

I am in receipt of your order for 280 pairs of PC cables	Thank you for your recent order for 280 pairs of PC cables
You failed to send your order to us before the new prices were introduced	Unfortunately, we did not receive your order before the new prices were introduced
We cannot devote much time to your visit as the Year-end Sales Figures are being compiled and we are extremely busy	We shall devote as much time to your visit as our tight schedule will permit

Don’ts in writing e-mail message:

- find fault with or criticize the receiver
- shirk responsibility
- disregard or ignore the problems your customers are faced with
- refuse to help the receiver
- not show or express your gratitude & appreciation for the favor

I am in receipt of the upgraded software you sent to replace the software we bought in Nov.

Thank you very much for sending me upgraded software which supersedes that which we bought in Nov.

It is not our fault if you do not check whether goods are satisfactory on delivery

We don't have time to send our salesmen to see you. They are busy dealing with larger accounts than yours

Try to use more of the tones “You approach”, esp. in the case of the positive things; otherwise, use “I approach”. Look at the following examples:

We shall be able to deliver PC cables shortly

You will soon be able to receive PC cables

I regret to inform you that we cannot refund the deposit unless you return the goods within a week

I am happy to inform you that you will be able to receive a full refund of deposit if you return the goods

I am afraid we cannot deliver the goods at the weekend

You can have your goods delivered any weekday

5. Checkup (proofread)

After you have finished your e-mail messages, you are supposed to go through what you have written and mark ***yes or no*** on your checklist:

No Yes

- Any mistakes in spelling
- Any mistakes in grammar
- All information and details are included & accurate
- Tone is pleasing

Click the button “Send”

Assignment: proofread the following message and correct where necessary

Dear Mr. Tom:

Thnk you for your letter of 31 September I was surprised and dissappointed to hear that you have been experiencing problems the with ‘Sunrise microwave oven’ that you bought from our branch in Hongkong. We shall of course be pleased to give you a full refund of HK$3,500 if you could bring the machine into our Customer Service Sectoin (address down below. We ssure you that your your experience is not

common, and hope that we shall be able to serve you again in the naer future.

Yours Faithfully!

Jack Ma

manager of Customer Service section

Assignments: Change the following sentences but be faithful to its original meaning

1. We shall be able to deliver the goods before this Sunday.
2. Thank you very much for your help.
3. Let me know the updates.
4. I am sorry we couldn’t satisfy your requirements.
5. Your top quality has led to the top excellence performance of your products.
6. We regard your company as our best vendor

Assignments: change between You & I approach

- I am happy to tell you that I can meet you today in Hongkong.
- We can offer you a discount of 12% on list prices.
- You could have addressed the worst situation.
- You must be responsible for the loss of that huge order.